out to Muslims' and soon introduced him to a Lashkar recruiter tasked with sending Indian youths for training in Pakistan.[114] Not long after, Sabauddin crossed the LoC into Pakistan-administered Kashmir and enrolled in his first Lashkar training program. Upon completion of the initial program, Sabauddin and others were taken to a camp in Punjab province for additional training with weapons and explosives. Lashkar's operational commander, Zaki-ur Rehman Lakhvi, then directed him to work with the ISI who Sabauddin told investigators prepared a Pakistani passport and other documents for him. He used these to travel to Bangalore via Kathmandu, Dhaka, Colombo and the United Arab Emirates.[115]

Sabauddin arrived in Bangalore in 2004 and, at Lashkar's direction, began to survey possible targets for a terrorist attack. He told police the group chose Bangalore because it was enjoying an economic boom. This fact, coupled with the city's growing reputation as a global hub for the IT industry, meant an attack would harm India economically and attract international attention. Working with a Pakistani commander known as Abu Hamza [an alias], for whom Sabauddin also provided safe haven, the two identified four possible targets. According to police they zeroed in on the Indian Institute of Science [IISc], which Sabauddin confessed to reconnoitering a day prior to the attack, because it was hosting an international conference. On 28 December 2005 the two men launched a fidayeen assault, storming the auditorium where a seminar was in progress and killing a professor who was visiting from Delhi. Abu Hamza escaped to Pakistan while Sabauddin fled to Nepal, where he went on to become a top Lashkar commander and allegedly oversaw the movement of operatives transiting between India and Pakistan. On 31 December 2007 he became the first Indian operative to command Pakistani fighters during a Lashkar fidayeen attack, when a team of militants assaulted a Central Reserve Police Force [CRPF] camp in Rampur in the Indian state of Uttar Pradesh.[116]

The outcome of Sabauddin's journey was exceptional. Most Indian jihadis were not used to support, much less lead, fidayeen assaults. Rather they were part of a loosely knit movement responsible for a host of bombing attacks, executed with varying degrees of external direction and support. These bombings increased in terms of frequency and scale during the early years of the decade, a result of an expanded pool of would-be